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AI Mobile Engineer

Imagine taking a picture of a receipt and your app automatically extracts the shop name, date, and total amount. Or uploading a document and getting its key information instantly.

What is Vision AI?

- Vision AI: Enables AI to analyze and understand images.
- Image Analysis: Identify objects, describe scenes, understand screenshots, and answer questions about images.
- Real-world example: Upload a product image and ask AI to describe it.

What is OCR?

- OCR (Optical Character Recognition): Extracts readable text from images.
- Use cases: Scanning receipts, reading ID cards, digitizing printed notes, and extracting text from screenshots.
- Important: OCR extracts text, but it does not always understand the meaning of that text.

What is Document AI?

- Document AI: Extracts and organizes meaningful information from documents.
- Examples: Identify invoice numbers, dates, customer names, and total amounts.
- OCR vs Document AI: OCR reads the text; Document AI helps identify what that text represents.

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How They Work Together

- Step 1: User captures or uploads an image.
- Step 2: Vision AI analyzes the visual content.
- Step 3: OCR extracts text when needed.
- Step 4: Document AI organizes relevant information into structured data.
- Step 5: The app validates the results and displays them.

Practical Mobile App Examples

- Receipt scanner for expense tracking.
- Document scanner for extracting information from invoices.
- AI study app that reads notes and explains their content.
- Shopping app that identifies products from images.

Production Best Practices

- Handle blurry, rotated, or low-quality images.
- Validate extracted amounts, dates, and other important fields.
- Ask users to review extracted data before saving it.
- Protect sensitive documents and personal information.
- Keep secret AI API keys on a secure backend, not inside the mobile app.